

ADMAPS Lifecycle Checklist V1

Intervention-Aware Auditing for Public-Sector Algorithmic Decision-Making

Operationalized from:

Devansh Saxena, Karla Badillo-Urquiola, Pamela J. Wisniewski, and Shion Guha. 2021. A Framework of High-Stakes Algorithmic Decision-Making for the Public Sector Developed through a Case Study of Child-Welfare. *Proc. ACM Hum.-Comput. Interact.* 5, CSCW2, Article 348 (October 2021), 41 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3476089>

Purpose: Use this checklist to examine algorithmic systems as interventions embedded in public-sector practice rather than as standalone technical tools. The checklist supports design review, audit, procurement, governance, and post-deployment evaluation. This checklist operationalizes the ADMAPS framework. A separate framework companion in this repository provides conceptual grounding.

1. Problem Framing and Decision Context

- What decision is the algorithm intervening in, and where in the workflow?
- What human judgment and discretion already exist at this point?
- What is framed as optimizable, and what contextual factors are excluded?
- Who bears the risk if the system is wrong?

2. Data, Targets, and Institutional Processes

- How are data produced through bureaucratic and organizational processes?
- What assumptions are embedded in proxies, labels, and targets?
- Where can feedback loops, strategic behavior, or gaming occur?
- What uncertainties stem from institutional practice rather than data quality?

3. Algorithm Use in Practice

- Who encounters the output, and under what constraints (time, workload, authority)?
- How does the system reshape discretion, responsibility, or professional judgment?

- What workarounds, resistance, or reinterpretations are likely?
- How is uncertainty communicated or suppressed in everyday use?

4. Governance, Accountability, and Oversight

- Who is accountable for design, deployment, use, and failure?
- How are overrides, exceptions, and disagreements handled?
- What governance exists beyond abstract human-in-the-loop claims?
- Who can modify, suspend, or retire the system?

5. Evaluation as Intervention

- What outcomes matter beyond predictive performance?
- How does the system affect practice, discretion, and professional labor?
- What impacts occur at the agency level or beyond affected individuals?
- What evidence would justify changing or discontinuing the system?

Intended use: Design reviews; algorithm audits; procurement and governance discussions; post-deployment evaluation of high-stakes public-sector systems.

Attribution: Operationalizes the ADMAPS framework. Cite Saxena et al., CSCW 2021.